Experiment 14

Pro-Code Extension Using Zoho Catalyst

Aim

To study and implement pro-code extension using Zoho Catalyst to extend the functionality of a low-code application by developing custom backend logic, APIs, database operations, and advanced features that go beyond the built-in capabilities of Zoho Creator.

Introduction

Zoho Catalyst is a pro-code development platform that enables developers to build, deploy, and manage applications using programming languages and cloud-based services. It supports backend functions, data storage, API development, authentication, and integrations.

Pro-code extension combines the rapid development capabilities of low-code platforms such as Zoho Creator with the flexibility of custom programming. This approach helps developers implement advanced business logic, complex calculations, and specialized integrations.

Procedure

1. Open the Zoho Catalyst website (catalyst.zoho.com) and click Access Catalyst to sign in with your Zoho account.
2. Create a new Catalyst project (for example, Project-Rainfall) and open its console.
3. Open CloudScale to view the available components: Authentication, Data Store, File Store, Web Client Hosting, API Gateway, Cron, and others.
4. Review the Install CLI section. Install the Catalyst command-line tool using npm, log in with the catalyst login command, and initialise the project with the catalyst init command.
5. Open the Data Store and create a table (for example, studentadmission) to hold the application data.
6. Review the table schema, which contains the system columns ROWID, CREATORID, CREATEDTIME, and MODIFIEDTIME, and add further columns as required.
7. Use the Catalyst services, such as serverless functions and the API Gateway, to provide custom backend logic that the Zoho Creator application can call.

Output Screenshots

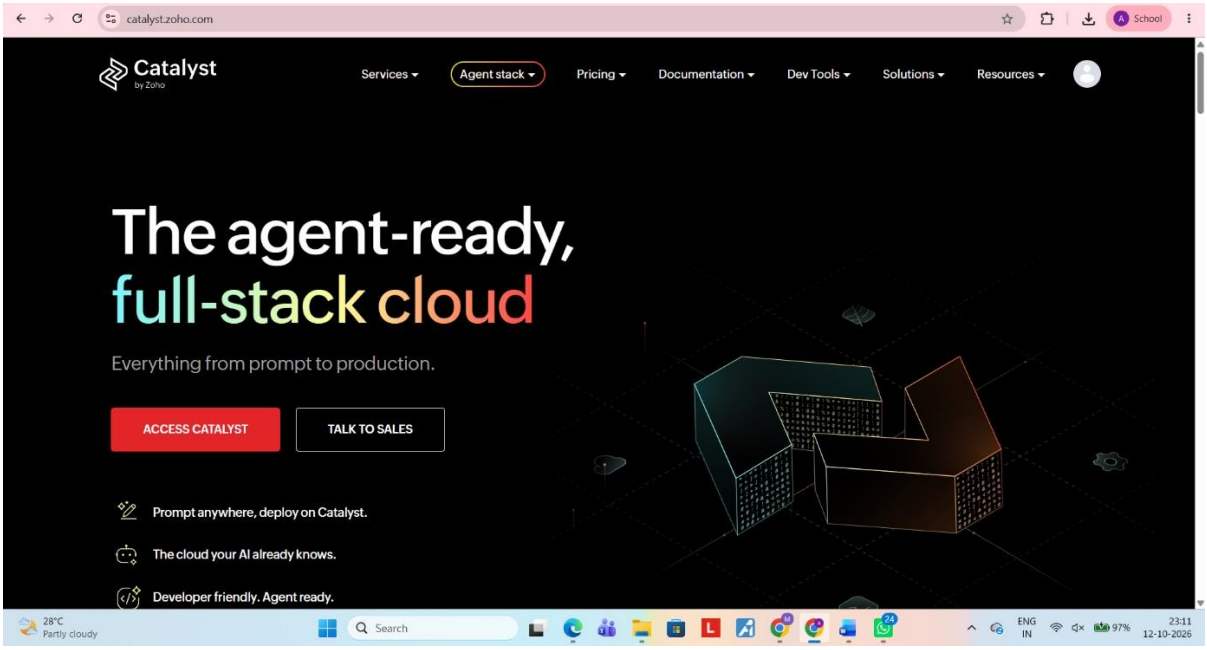


Figure 14.1

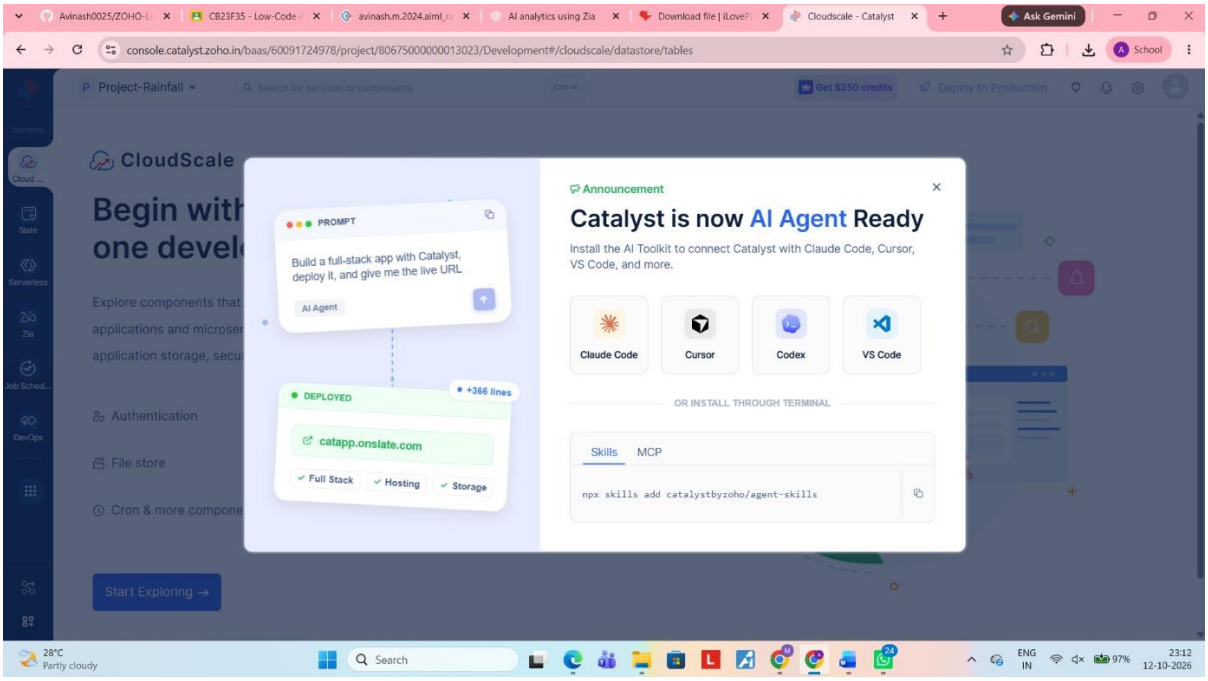


Figure 14.2

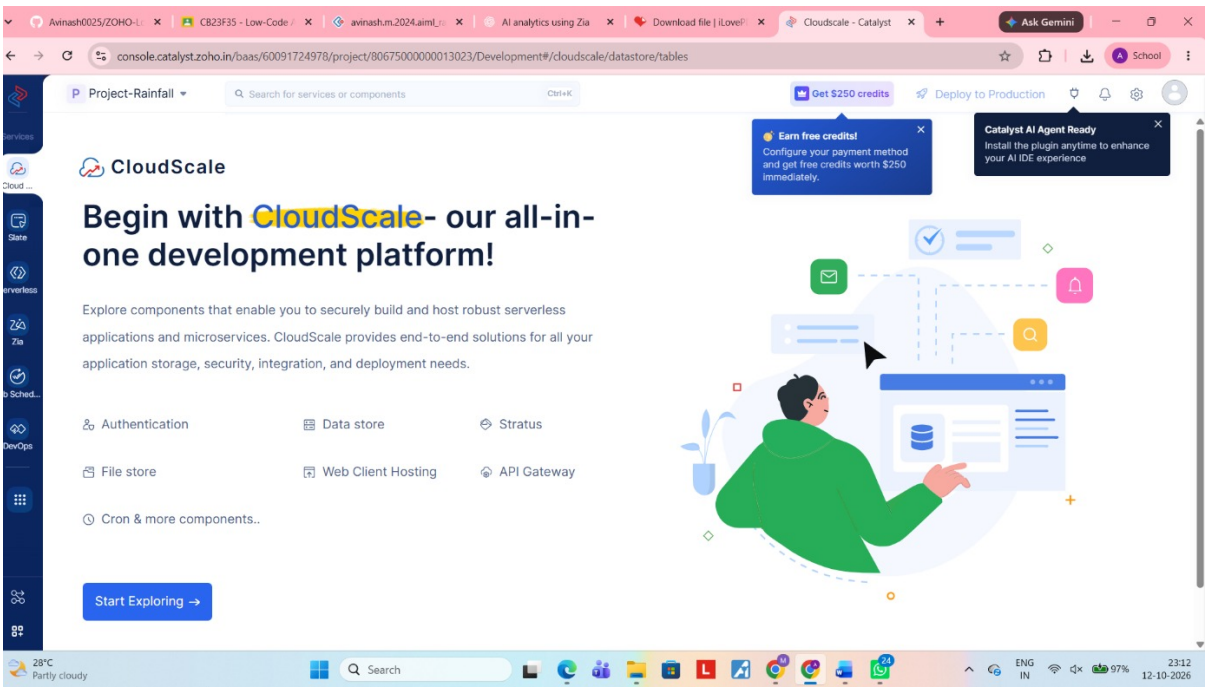


Figure 14.3

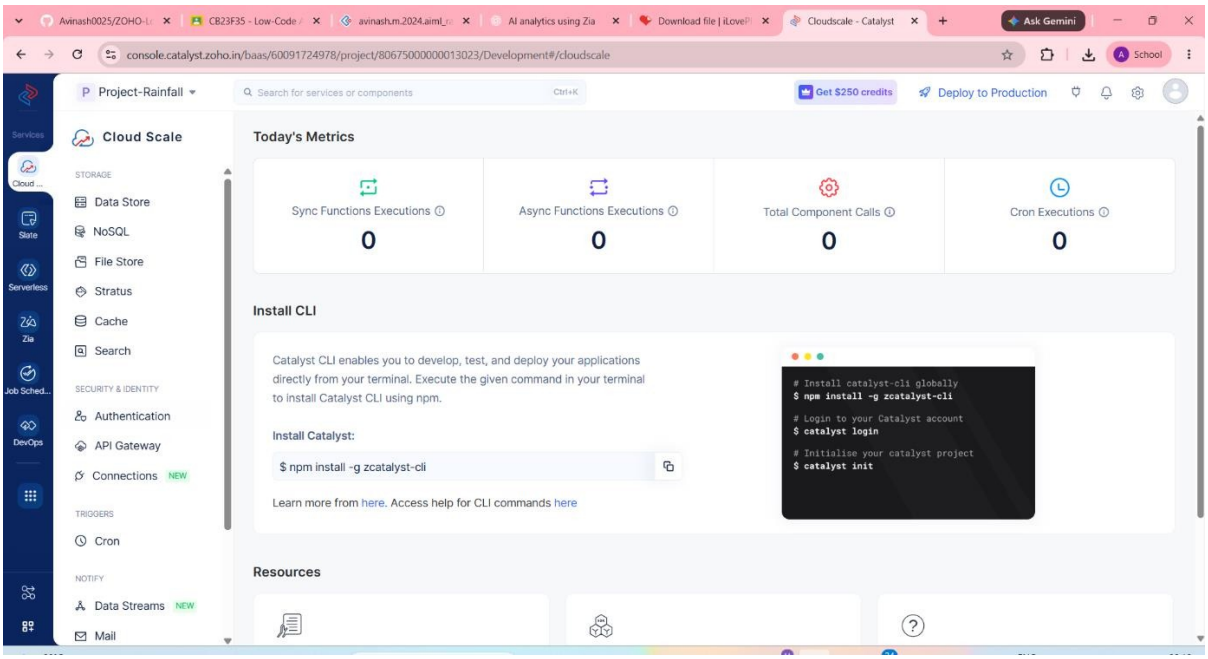


Figure 14.4

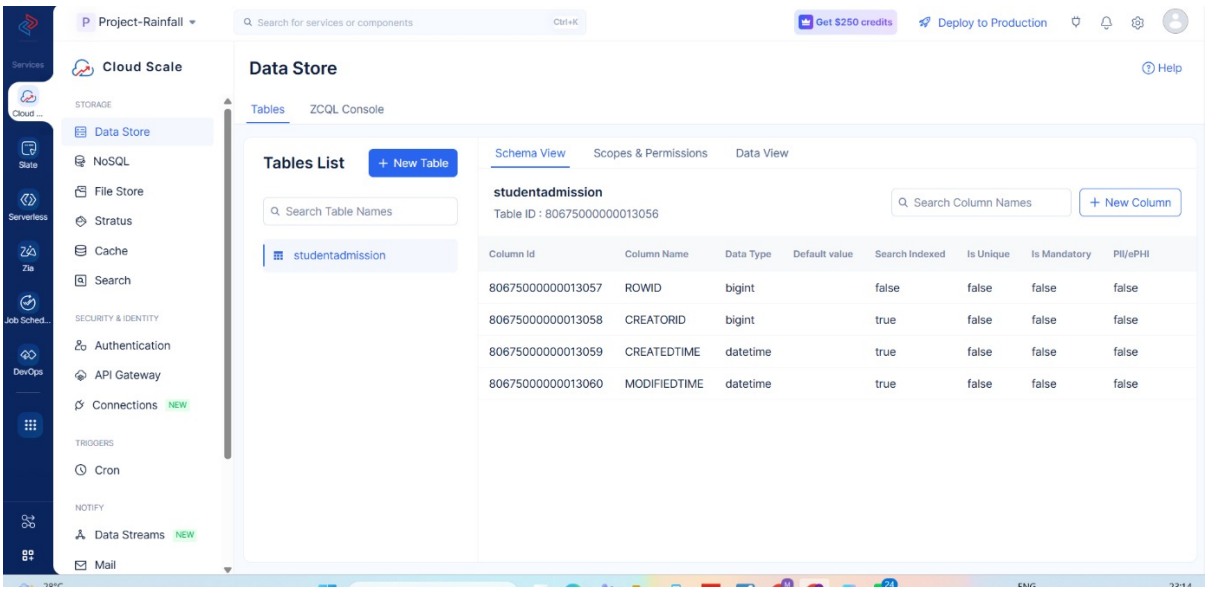


Figure 14.5

Result

Thus, the Zoho Catalyst project and its CloudScale Data Store were set up, and the pro-code extension approach for extending a Zoho Creator application was studied.

Conclusion

Pro-code extension using Zoho Catalyst combines the rapid development benefits of low-code platforms with the flexibility of traditional programming. It enables developers to create custom backend services, integrate external applications, and implement advanced functionality. This approach is useful when an application requires capabilities beyond the standard features available in Zoho Creator.